

# Wei(Rocio) Zhong

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| CONTACT INFORMATION   | Department of Political Science<br>Stony Brook University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | wei.zhong.1@stonybrook.edu<br><a href="https://rociozhong.github.io">https://rociozhong.github.io</a> |
| ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS | <b>Stony Brook University</b> , Stony Brook, NY<br>Department of Political Science<br><br>Assistant Professor, Sep 2025 – Present<br><br><b>New York University</b> , New York, NY<br>Center for Social Media and Politics<br><br>Postdoctoral Research Scientist, Sep 2023 – Aug 2025<br><br><b>George Washington University</b> , Washington, DC<br>Institute for Data, Democracy & Politics, School of Engineering and Applied Science<br><br>Research Scientist, Feb 2021 – Aug 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                       |
| EDUCATION             | <b>University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign</b> , Urbana, IL<br><br>Ph.D., Political Science, Aug 2021<br>Dissertation: “Candidates, the Economy and Voting Behavior”<br><br>M.S., Statistics, May 2018<br><br><b>New York University</b> , New York, NY<br><br>M.A., Politics, May 2014<br><br><b>University of International Business and Economics</b> , Beijing, China<br><br>B.A., Spanish, Jun 2009                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                       |
| RESEARCH INTEREST     | Comparative Politics, Political Methodology<br>Online Hate and Extremism, Polarization, Social Media, Computational Methods                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                       |
| PUBLICATIONS          | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , & Broniatowski, D.A. (2023). Economic risk framing increases intention to vaccinate among Republican COVID-19 vaccine refusers. <i>Social Science &amp; Medicine</i> , 317, 115594.<br><br>Bailard, C., Tromble, R., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Bianchi, F., Hosseini, P., & Broniatowski, D.A. (2024). “Keep Your Heads Held High Boys!”: Examining the Relationship between the Proud Boys’ Online Discourse and Offline Activities. <i>American Political Science Review</i> , 1–18.<br><br><b>Zhong, W.</b> , Bailard, C., Broniatowski, D., & Tromble, R. (2024). Proud Boys on Telegram. <i>Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media</i> , 4, 1–47.<br><br><b>Zhong, W.</b> , & Zhang, M. (2025). Subdued but Unbroken: The Cohesion of Far-Right Extremist Followers after Deplatforming. <i>Perspectives on Politics</i> , 1-26.<br><br>Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Brown, M.A., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Dahlke, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. <i>Social Media+ Society</i> , 11(2).<br><br><b>Zhong, W.</b> , Chen, B., Liang, F. & Zhang, M. (2025). Picturing Protest: A Deep Dive into the Visual Representation of Protests in Authoritarian Countries’ Media on Twitter. <i>Digital Journalism</i> , 1-22<br><br>Broniatowski, D., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , W., Simons, J.R., Jamison, A.M., Dredze, M., & Abrams, L.C. (2025). Explaining Twitter’s inability to effectively moderate content during the COVID-19 pandemic. <i>Scientific Reports</i> , 15(1), 36096. |                                                                                                       |

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|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------|
|                                        | Lukito, J., Pruden, M. L., Suk, J., Yang, Y., & <b>Zhong, W.</b> (2026). Political Communication Special Issue Introduction: Multi-Platform Research. <i>Political Communication</i> , 43(2), 175–191.                                                                                                     |  |                        |
|                                        | Lukito, J., Zhang, Y., Chen, B., Prochaska, S., Pruden, M.L., Yang, Y., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Brown, M., Dahlke, R., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., & Borah, P. (Forthcoming). Cross-Platformization: How U.S. Right-Leaning Media Curate Their Posts on Twitter and Truth Social. <i>New Media &amp; Society</i> . |  |                        |
| UNDER REVIEW                           | Suk, J.*, <b>Zhong, W.*</b> , Zhang, Y., Pruden M., Yang, Y., Mao, C., & DiFranzo D. Unveiling Engagement and Platform Algorithmic Biases in Social Media Data Collection and Analysis: An Experimental Study. (R&R) [*co-first author]                                                                    |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Zhong, W.</b> From Policy to Personality: How Americans Evaluate Presidential Candidates, 1984–2020. (R&R)                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                        |
|                                        | Sanderson, Z.*, <b>Zhong, W.*</b> , & Tucker, J.A. It Works When It Works: Measuring the Direct and Indirect Effects of AI Labels on Political Images. (R&R) [*co-first author]                                                                                                                            |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Tan, H., Wang, B., & Zhang, K. Self-reinforcing media antagonism sustains U.S.-China rivalry                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Zhang, Y., & Xu, Y. Territorial Contraction: Far-Right Mobilization and Everyday Public Life in American Neighborhoods                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                        |
| SELECTED<br>WORKS IN<br>PROGRESS       | Bisbee J, & <b>Zhong, W.</b> WLM Telegram: Images and Text                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Much, M., Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Tweets and Beliefs: Online Political Environments and Immigration Attitudes                                                                                                                                                                        |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , & Nagler, J. Opinion Change and Voter Learning across Political Issues in U.S. Elections.                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Xu, X., & Chen, H. The Rise and Contestation of Identity in Global Media                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |                        |
|                                        | Barrie, C., Zhang, M., <b>Zhong, W.</b> , Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Social Media and Cross-Cutting Conversations                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |                        |
| GRANTS &<br>AWARDS                     | <b>China and AI Research Award</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  | 2026                   |
|                                        | Paul and Marcia Wythes Center on Contemporary China, Princeton University<br>(with <b>Xu Xu</b> , Princeton University)                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>FAHSS Research Grant</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  | 2026                   |
|                                        | Faculty of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences, Stony Brook University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>FAHSS Travel Grant</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  | 2026                   |
|                                        | Faculty of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences, Stony Brook University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |                        |
| SELECTED<br>PROFESSIONAL<br>EXPERIENCE | <b>US 2020 Presidential Election Researcher</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  | Dec 2021 - Sep 2023    |
|                                        | META (formerly Facebook)<br>Menlo Park, CA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |                        |
|                                        | <b>Data Science Research Intern</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  | May 2019 - Aug 2019    |
|                                        | DiDi AI LABS<br>Beijing, China                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |                        |
| TEACHING<br>EXPERIENCE                 | <b>Instructor</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |                        |
|                                        | POL 201 Introduction to Statistical Methods in Political Science, SBU                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  | Spring 2026            |
|                                        | POL 604 Quantitative Analysis III (Graduate), SBU                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  | Fall 2025              |
|                                        | PS 385 Politics of the European Union (Online), UIUC                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  | Spring 2020            |
|                                        | PS 241 Comparative Politics in Developing Nations (Online), UIUC                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  | Fall 2019, Spring 2018 |

**Teaching Assistant**

Quantitative Analysis I, II, III (Graduate), UIUC

Introduction to Political Research, UIUC

Introduction to International Relations, UIUC

2018–2019

Spring 2017

Spring 2016

**LANGUAGES**

English(fluent), Chinese(native), Spanish(proficient)

**SOFTWARE**

Python, R, SQL, LATEX, Git, ArcGIS

**SERVICES****Manuscript Referee**

American Political Science Review, Political Behavior, Political Communication, Journal of Experimental Political Science, PNAS Nexus, Nature Communications

**Guest Editor**

Special Issue on Multi-Platform Research for *Political Communication*